

EDM 101 – Ethics and Patients' Rights in Dental Medicine

Lecture 2

Principal Features of Dental Ethics

Dr. Barzi Barzan M Fadhil

BDS, MSc, Advanced Aesthetic Restorative Dentistry



barzi.barzan@auis.edu.krd



Drbarzibarzan



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

This classes learning outcomes

By the end of this lecture you are able to

- Understand what makes dental ethics important in dentistry.
- Recognize the main ethical principles and professional values in dental practice.
- Use basic ethical reasoning to discuss simple clinical cases.



Why do we study Dental Ethics?

1. Ethics is part of everyday dentistry
2. Technical skill alone is not enough
3. Ethical conflicts happen during normal treatment



What makes Dentistry Ethically Challenging?

- Patients trust dentists with their bodies
- Procedures may be painful or irreversible
- Information imbalance
- Dentistry combines healthcare and business



Dentists' Dual Role;

- Patient welfare
- Financial sustainability



Who Makes The Decision, What is Ethical?

A. Personal values

B. Professional codes

C. Law

D. Society and culture

E. Professional organizations



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Core Ethical Principles of (ADA Framework)

Principal

Meaning

Autonomy

Respect patient choices

Beneficence

Act for the patient's advantage

Non-maleficence

Do no harm

Justice

Fair treatment

Veracity

Truthfulness



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Ethical Principles Compete

Ethical conflicts happen when principles clash:

- Autonomy vs beneficence
- Justice vs personal preference
- Truthfulness vs patient anxiety



Patient's Care



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI
زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Autonomy

(Patient's choice guides the treatments)

Patient's Care



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Autonomy

(Patient's choice guides the treatments)

Patient's Care

Beneficence

What benefits the patient



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Autonomy

(Patient's choice guides the treatments)

Patient's Care

Beneficence

What benefits the patient

Non-maleficence

(We avoid harm)



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Autonomy

(Patient's choice guides the treatments)

Justice

Maintaining fairness and equality

Patient's Care

Non-maleficence

(We avoid harm)

Beneficence

What benefits the patient



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Values that we need to adhere with

1.Compassion

2.Competence

3.Respect

4.Integrity

5.Confidentiality



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمەریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Confidentiality (Everyday Ethics)

Why does it matter?

- Patient trust
- Privacy
- Professional responsibility



Does Ethics Change Over Time?

- Principles are stable

But

- Applications can change

Digital records

Social media

Online marketing



Ethics Across Countries

A. Culture

B. Law

C. Healthcare resources



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Ethical Thinking

1. Identify the ethical problem
2. Who is affected?
3. What principles apply?
4. What options exist?
5. Choose & justify a decision



Case;

Nurse asks to do scaling of colleague's teeth during lunch break.



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمەریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Case;

Parent refuses extraction for child with severe decay.



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI

زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية

Thank You!



AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF IRAQ, SULAIMANI
زانكۆی ئەمریکی له عێراق، سلێمانی | الجامعة الأمريكية في العراق، السليمانية